environment, climate change, ozone depletion, carbon emission, and a host of other problems, making the future of the Earth bleak. Among these, the most significant was the Rio Declaration of 1992 underlying the 27 principles of sustainable development.

Through ratification of international human rights treaties, governments undertake to put into place the domestic measures and legislation compatible with their treaty obligations and duties. Where domestic legal proceedings fail to address human rights abuses, mechanisms and procedures for individual complaints or communications are available at the regional and international levels to help ensure that international human rights standards are indeed respected, implemented and enforced at the local level. The principle of universality of human rights is the cornerstone of international human rights law. This principle, as first emphasized in the Universal Declaration of Human Rights in 1948, has been reiterated in numerous international human rights conventions, declarations and resolutions. The 1993 Vienna World Conference on Human Rights, for example, noted that it is the duty of the states to promote and protect all human rights and fundamental freedoms, irrespective of their political, economic and cultural systems.